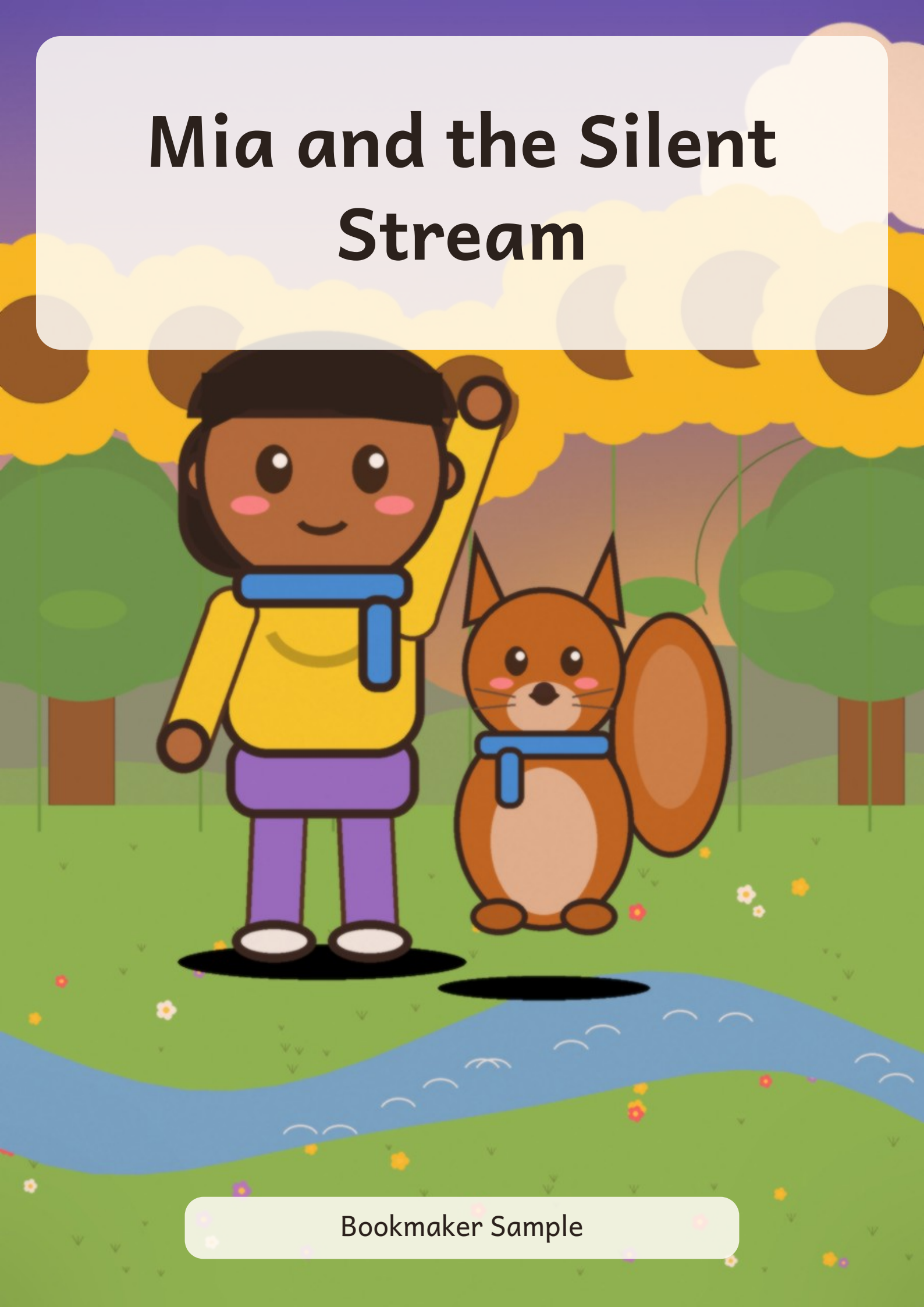
Mia and the Silent Stream



Bookmaker Sample

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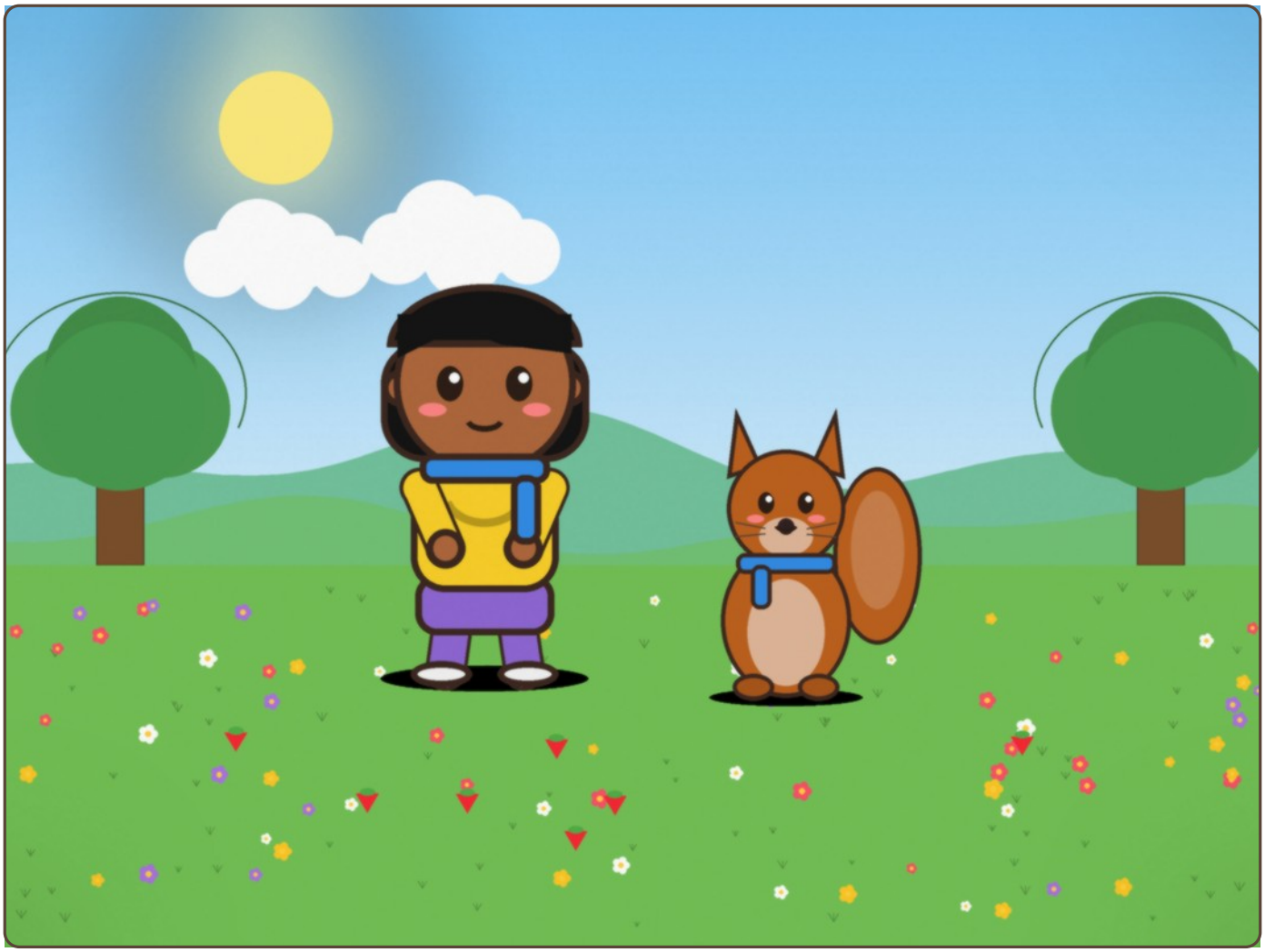
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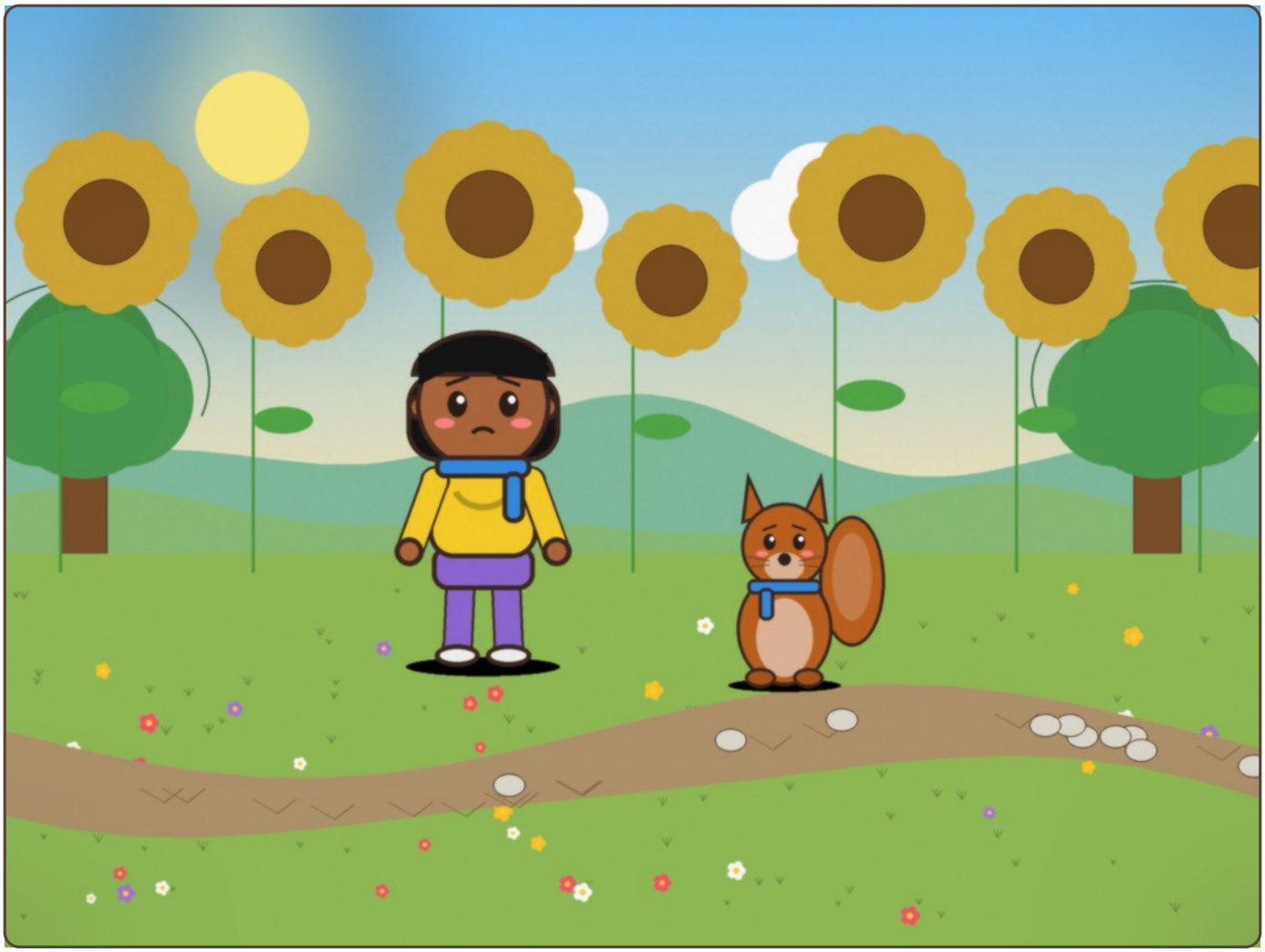
Mia and the Silent Stream
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In a sunny little village, the best place of all was the shared garden, where a bright stream bubbled between the flower beds. Mia visited every morning to say hello to the flowers.



Mia's best garden friend was Nutmeg, a quick little squirrel, who knew every corner of every flower bed. Together, they knew where the sweetest strawberries hid and which flower opened first in the morning.



Then one scorching morning, Mia ran to the bridge and gasped. The stream was gone, and the flowers were wilting. Where water had flowed, there were only dry stones and cracked mud.



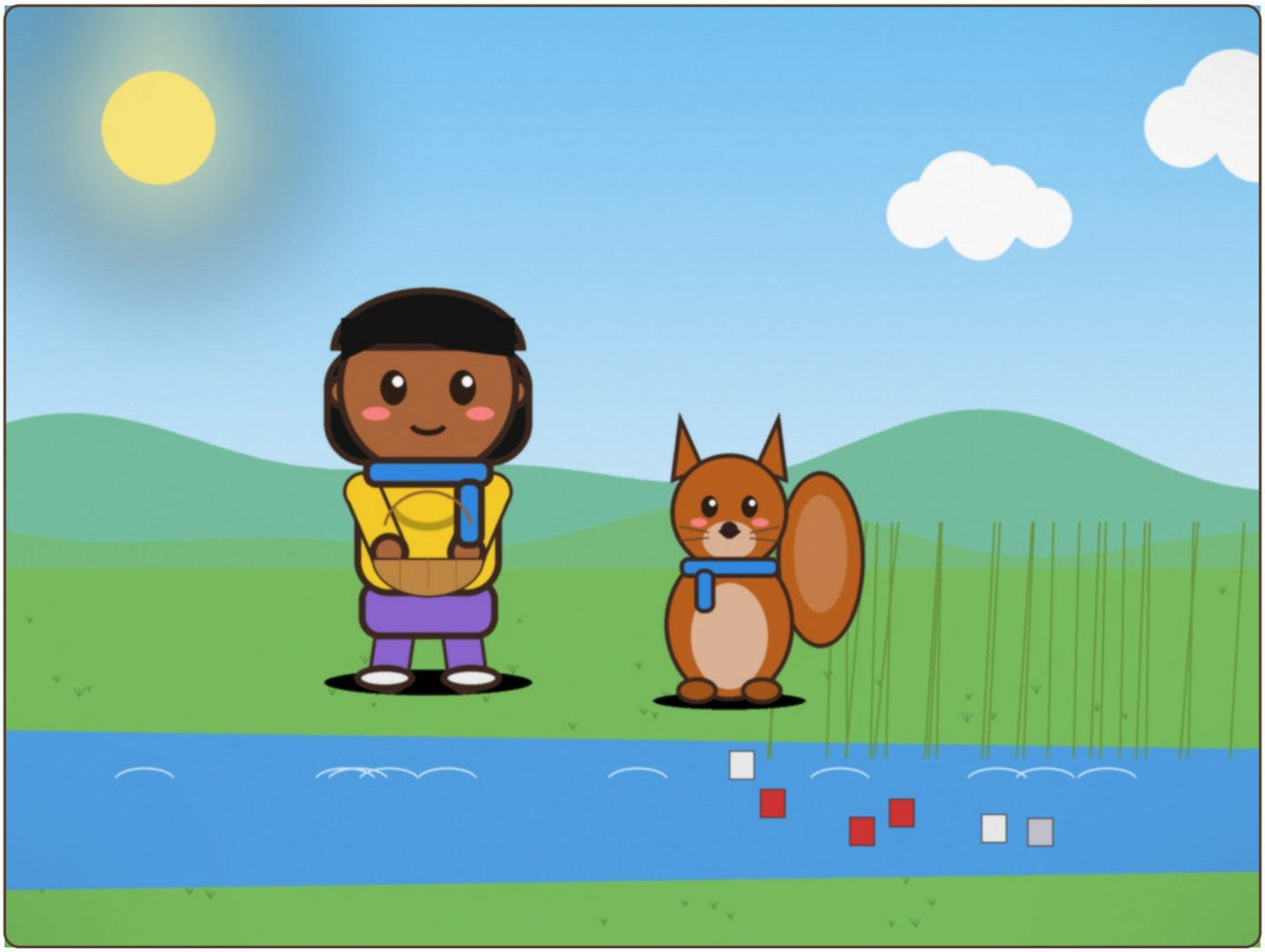
Mr. Bram, the old gardener, scratched his beard. 'Water always comes from somewhere,' he said. 'Follow the stream, and you'll find the answer.' So Mia and Nutmeg grabbed a basket and a watering can and set off upstream.



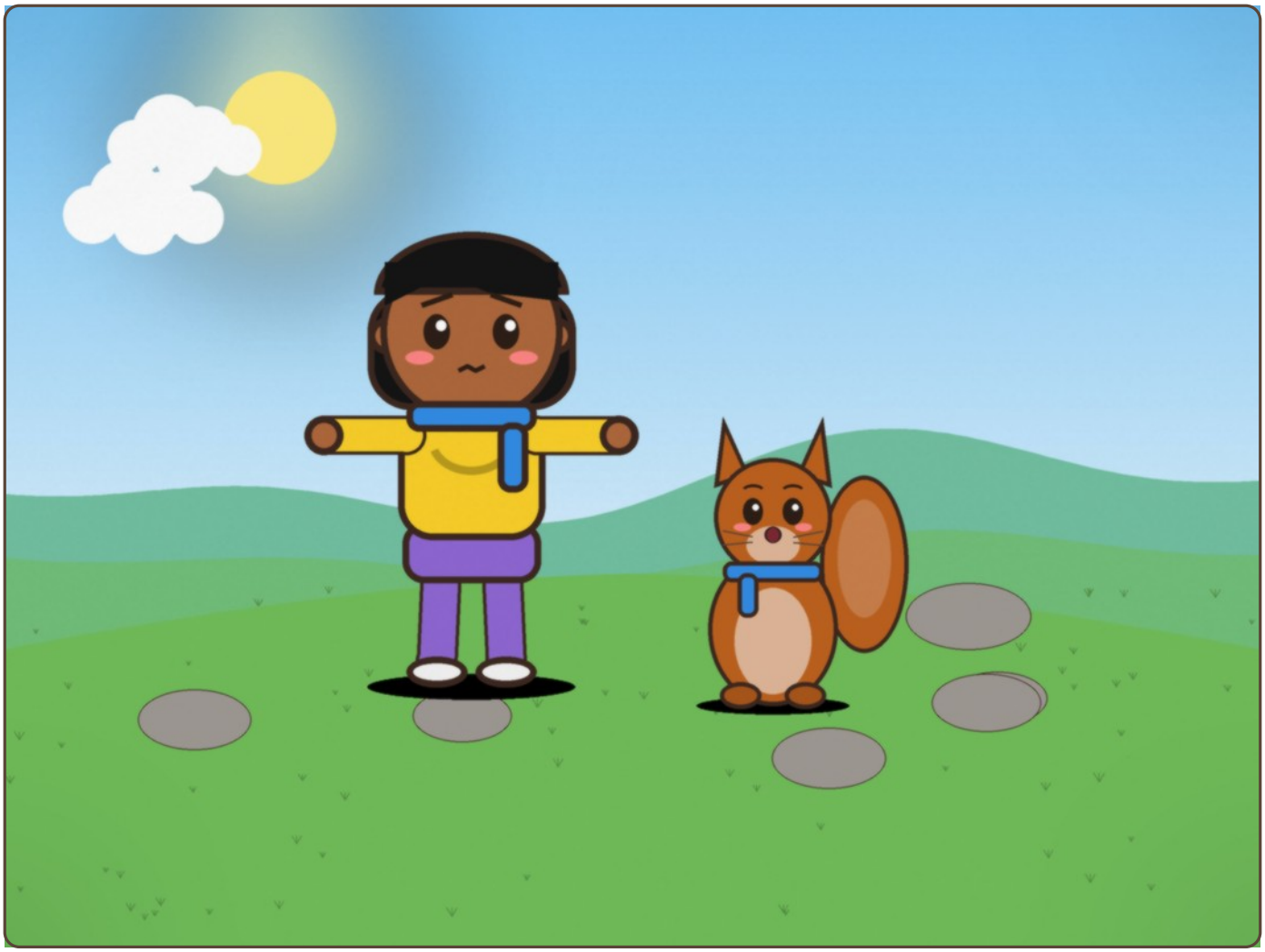
They walked along the dry streambed, past the willow trees and over the smooth white pebbles. Every few steps, Mia knelt down to look for clues.



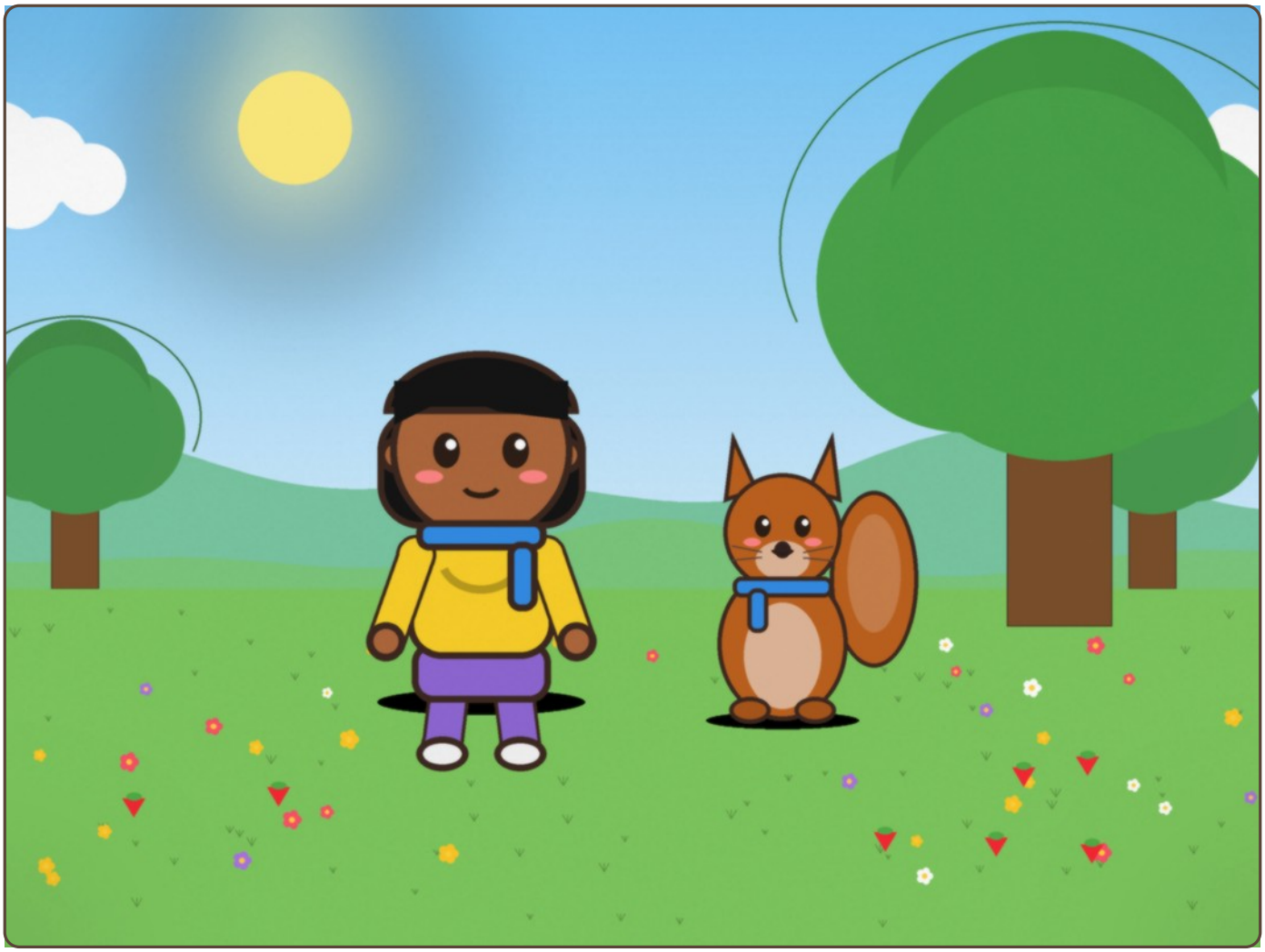
On the way, they met a family of thirsty ducks waddling in circles. Mia shared the water from the watering can. 'Don't worry,' she told them, 'we're going to fix this.'



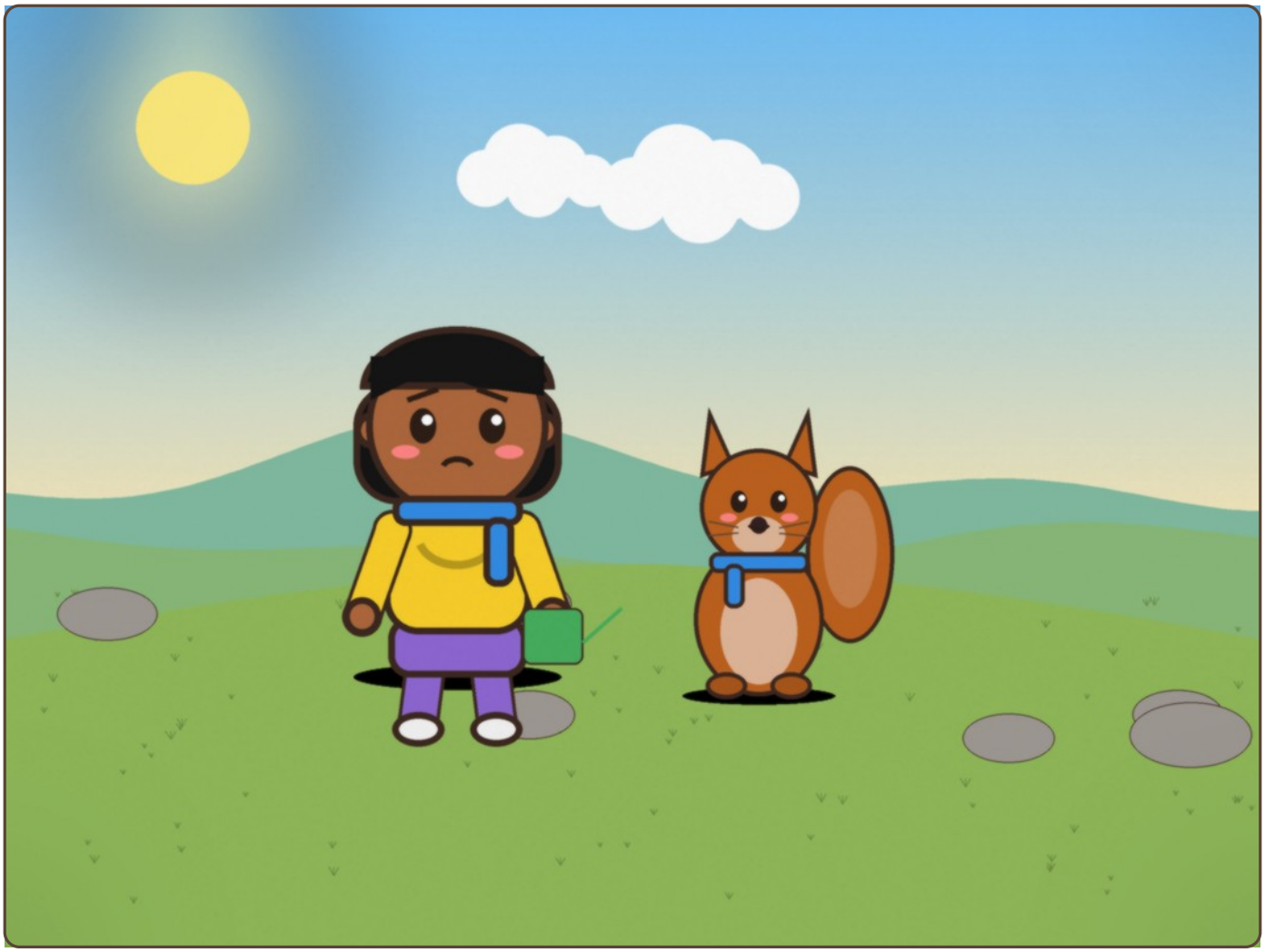
Further on, they found plastic bags and old cans caught in the reeds. Mia and Nutmeg picked up every piece and put it in their basket. 'The stream deserves better than this,' said Nutmeg.



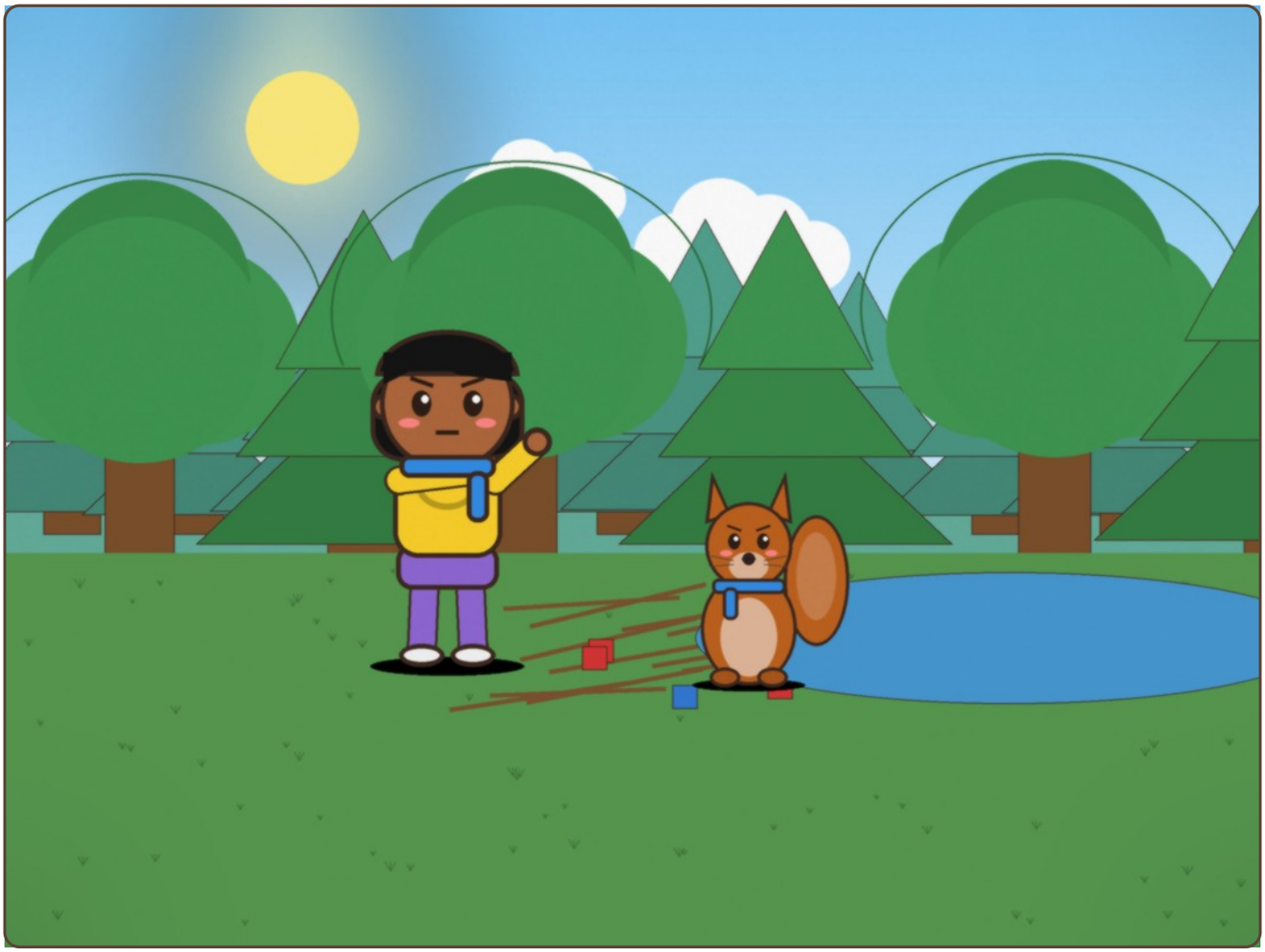
The path climbed up a steep, rocky slope. Nutmeg slipped, but Mia caught her just in time. 'Thanks,' said Nutmeg, catching her breath. 'Let's go slowly and carefully.'



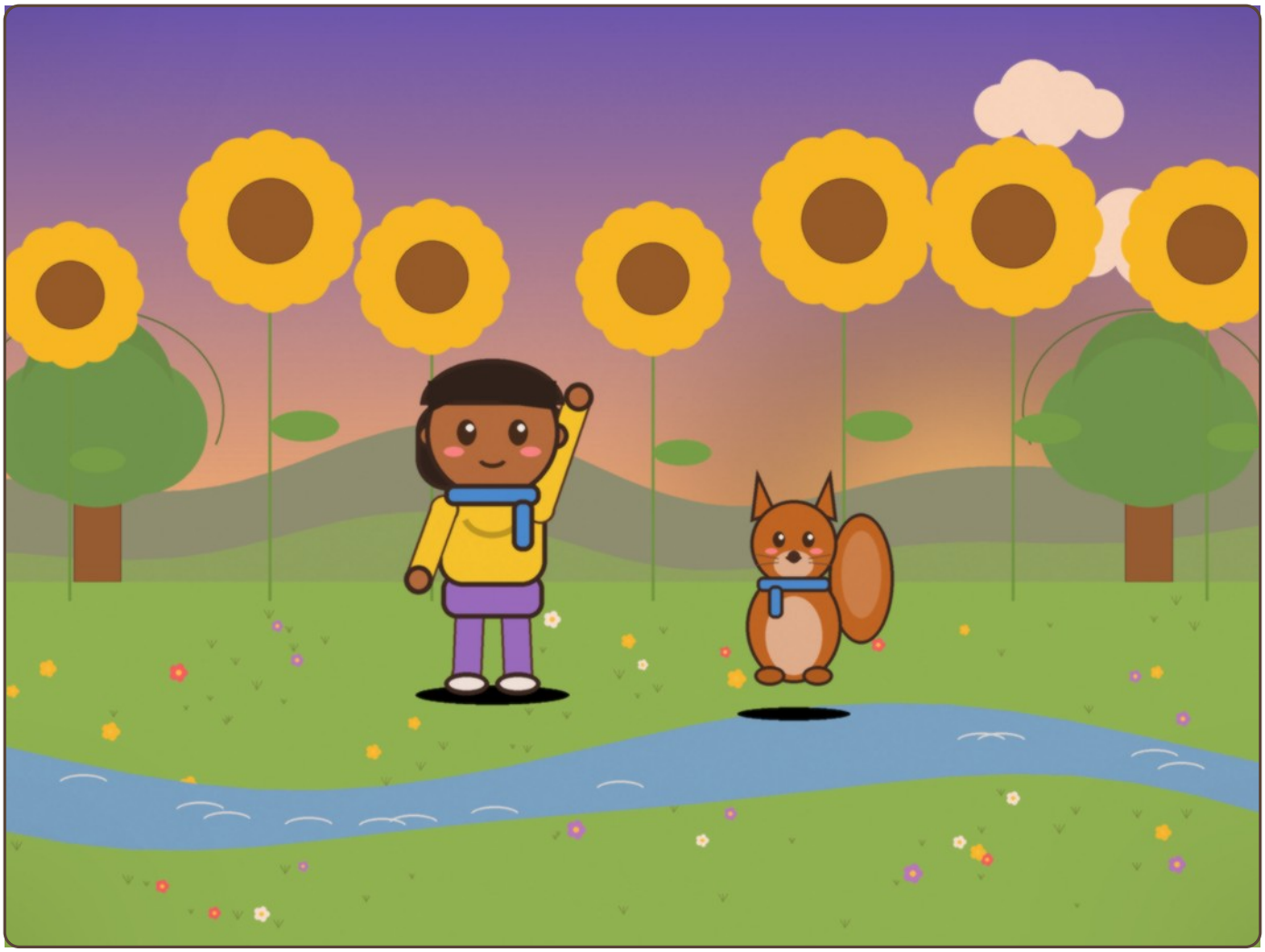
The sun was hot, so they rested in the shade of a big oak tree and shared a strawberry each. A breeze cooled their faces, and soon they felt ready to keep going.



The sun grew hotter and the path grew longer. Mia's feet hurt. 'Maybe we should go back,' she sighed. Then she thought of the drooping sunflowers and the worried little frog, and she kept walking.



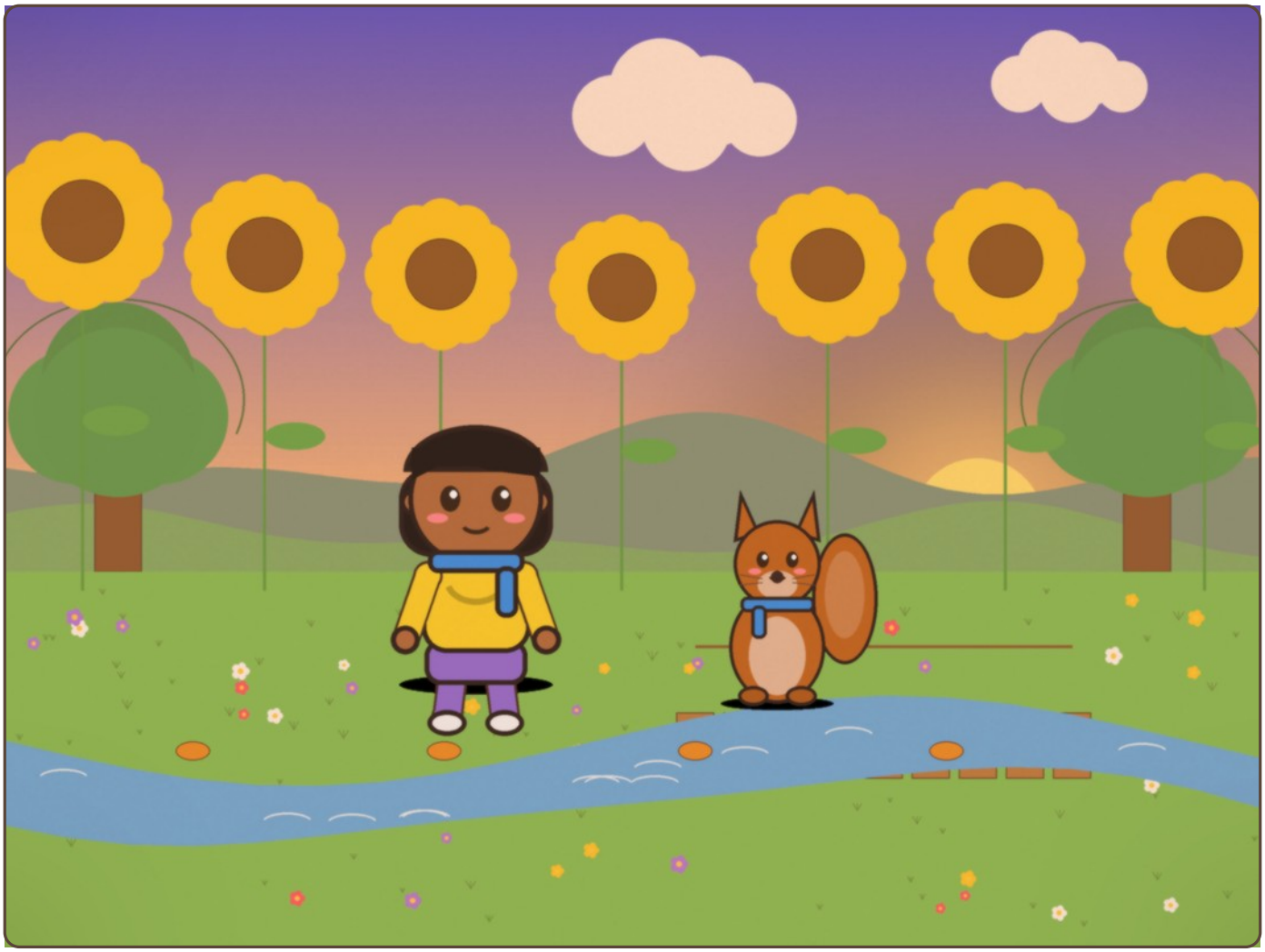
At the edge of the woods, they saw it at last: a tangled dam of branches, leaves, and trash, holding back all the water. It was much too heavy to move all at once. So they worked piece by piece, until the water rushed free.



Down the hill the stream ran, singing again, all the way home to the garden. By the time they returned, the sunflowers were lifting their heads.

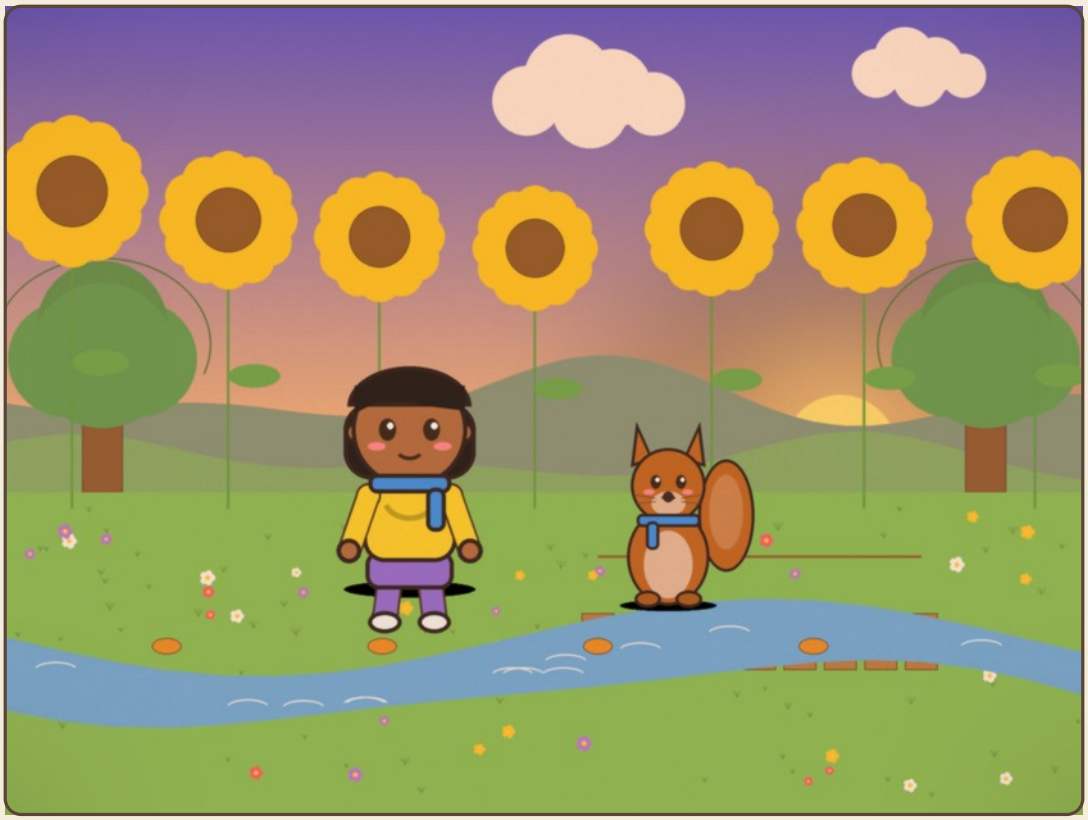


Mr. Bram and all the neighbors cheered, and the little frog jumped into the water with a happy SPLASH! Together, they planted new seeds along the stream, so its banks would stay green and strong.



Every morning after that, Mia walked up the stream to make sure the water could flow freely. And the garden grew more beautiful than ever. Every evening, the stream sang its gentle thank-you song.

The End



The stream has stopped singing and the sunflowers are drooping. Where did all the water go?